

PHISHING EMAIL DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

Future Interns – Cyber Security Task 2

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1. Introduction

Phishing is a cyber attack in which attackers attempt to trick users into revealing sensitive information such as usernames, passwords, banking details, or OTPs. The purpose of this report is to analyze a phishing email sample, identify phishing indicators, classify the risk level, and provide prevention guidelines to improve user awareness.

2. Phishing Email Sample

Subject: Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked

Dear User,

We noticed suspicious activity on your account.

To avoid account suspension, please verify your details immediately.

Verify Now:

<http://secure-account-verify.com>

Failure to verify within 24 hours will result in permanent account lock.

Regards,

Security Team

3. Email Analysis

The email was analyzed to identify common phishing characteristics used by attackers to deceive users.

Finding 1: Generic Greeting

The email uses "Dear User" instead of addressing the recipient by name. Legitimate organizations usually address customers using their registered names.

Finding 2: Urgent Language

The message creates a sense of urgency by claiming the account will be locked within 24 hours. Attackers use urgency to pressure users into making quick decisions.

Finding 3: Suspicious Link

The URL "secure-account-verify.com" appears suspicious and does not represent an official company domain. Users should always verify website addresses before clicking links.

Finding 4: Request for Verification

The email requests users to verify their details immediately. Such requests are commonly used to steal login credentials and personal information.

Finding 5: Fear-Based Tactics

The email threatens account suspension, which is a common social engineering technique used in phishing attacks.

4. Risk Classification

Risk Level: High

Classification: Phishing Email

Reason:

The email contains multiple phishing indicators including urgency, suspicious links, generic greetings, and attempts to collect sensitive information. Users interacting with this email may become victims of credential theft or identity theft.

5. Prevention Guidelines

Users should follow these best practices to avoid phishing attacks:

- Verify the sender's email address before responding.
- Carefully inspect website URLs before clicking links.
- Never share passwords or OTPs through email.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Report suspicious emails to the security team.
- Avoid downloading attachments from unknown senders.
- Contact the organization directly through official channels when in doubt.

6. Do's and Don'ts

Do's

- Verify sender information.
- Check links before clicking.
- Use strong passwords.
- Enable MFA.
- Report suspicious emails.

Don'ts

- Do not click unknown links.
- Do not share passwords.

- Do not share OTPs.
- Do not download suspicious attachments.
- Do not trust urgent requests without verification.

7. Conclusion

This phishing email analysis identified several indicators commonly used in phishing attacks, including urgency, suspicious links, generic greetings, and fear-based messaging. Proper user awareness and security best practices can significantly reduce the risk of successful phishing attacks. Organizations should continue conducting security awareness training to help users identify and report phishing attempts effectively.